

INVENTORY · GRID · STRUCTURE

cards-grid

2–4 parallel items, similar weight, scannable in a grid.

A cards grid gives equal weight to peers.

Parallel titles.

Noun phrases of similar weight, never mixed.

Short bodies.

One clause each; a long card collapses the grid.

Rank order.

Left to right reads strongest first.

Four cards.

The hard ceiling; five means a new slide.

four locks a two-by-two, compact tightens it.

Quadrant read.

Four cells scan as a loop.

Compact pairing.

Padding shrinks so labels stay whole.

Named corners.

Position carries meaning; place cards deliberately.

Still four.

The ceiling does not move.

three widens the grid to three columns.

Wider cards.

Each card earns a third of the row.

Same budget.

Bodies stay one clause, titles stay parallel.

Sweet spot.

Three peers is the count this grid loves.

An ordered list numbers the cards.

1

Numbers appear

Markdown's ordered list turns cards into steps.

2

Sequence reads

The grid now implies order, so mean it.

3

Budget holds

Same one-clause bodies as the unnumbered grid.

Four full cards is this grid's loud maximum.

Card one.

A body at the hard budget runs this long — two clauses that read as one breath, and not a word more.

Card two.

Parallel structure matters most at the ceiling; matching shapes are what keep four dense cards readable as a set.

Card three.

The grid trades white space for words here; past this density the audience reads one card and skips the rest.

Card four.

The hard stop. A fifth card or a longer body does not fit — split the slide or reach for list-tabular.

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When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

More than 4 items

Split into multiple slides instead. The grid loses scannability past 4 cards.

Order carries meaning

Use list-steps or `list takeaway numbered`. cards-grid is for parallel options, not sequences.

Lopsided density

Equalize the prose when one card has three sentences and the rest have one. Otherwise change layout.

When NOT to reach for cards-grid.

Inline-code-only body

A body bullet containing only `code` gets promoted to an eyebrow label. Mix it with surrounding prose.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`list-steps` — items carry an explicit sequence

`cards-stack` — items stack vertically as full-width rows

`compare-prose` — two-option comparison, side by side

`verdict-grid` — comparing options against shared criteria